

Stage 1 — Controlled Launch

Timing: Month 1–2 | Objective: Prove that real customers can successfully transact

Primary task

Launch to a deliberately constrained market and focus on completed, delivered transactions rather than downloads.

Customer acquisition

- Use founder-led outreach, WhatsApp, social content, communities, referrals and direct vendor audiences.
- Track acquisition source for every customer where practical.
- Interview early customers after purchase and after delivery.

Vendor acquisition

- Personally onboard the first vendors.
- Prioritize vendors who have reliable inventory, competitive pricing and an audience they can bring to Shopiva.
- Measure active vendors, products listed, orders received and vendor response time.

Transaction operations

- Monitor payment failures, abandoned checkouts, order cancellations, dispatch delays, delivery failures, refunds and disputes.
- Manually investigate unusual transactions and customer complaints.
- Record recurring operational failures as product or process issues to fix.

Core metrics

- Completed orders
- Delivered orders
- Gross merchandise value (GMV)
- Average order value (AOV)
- Checkout conversion
- Payment success rate
- Cancellation/refund rate
- First-to-second purchase rate

Lean Startup application

- Use the Build–Measure–Learn loop weekly: build the smallest change, measure a defined behavior, learn from evidence, then decide what to change next.
- Prefer behavioral evidence—completed purchases, repeat usage and vendor activity—over vanity metrics such as downloads alone.
- Keep experiments small enough that you can identify what caused a change.

Exit criteria

- Customers can complete transactions reliably.

- You have evidence of real demand from people outside your immediate personal network.
- You know the largest conversion and operational bottlenecks.
- You have a repeatable process for onboarding and supporting vendors.

Founder question: What behavior would convince us that Shopiva is solving a real problem rather than merely attracting curiosity?

Framework reference: Eric Ries, *The Lean Startup* (Crown Business, 2011). This roadmap applies Lean Startup concepts such as validated learning, the Build–Measure–Learn loop, minimum viable product (MVP), innovation accounting, and pivot/persevere decisions. It does not reproduce the book's text.